

THE ONE WITH BOLD STROKES

For Ritu Gangrade Arora, an avid painter, the canvas imitates professional growth, one that is constantly evolving

BY ANAND ADHIKARI

PHOTO BY HARDIK CHHABRA



96 |

WHAT ADVICE WOULD YOU GIVE TO YOUR YOUNGER SELF?

Believe in yourself. Don't be too hard on yourself

YOUR MANTRA FOR NAVIGATING CHALLENGES?

Challenges get resolved as long as you are willing to find solutions. Eventually, things do fall into place



RITU GANGRADE ARORA

51, Chief Executive Officer and Chief Investment Officer, Allianz Investment Management (AIM), Asia Pacific

RITU GANGRADE ARORA'S

career mirrors a canvas that she's continuously shaping. For an avid painter, the Covid-19 pandemic gave the opportunity to reconnect with her passion. Her professional journey reflects her diverse skills and creative adaptability.

The 51-year-old began her career as a brand analyst at domestic FMCG player Marico in the mid '90s. Although a short stint, she gained significant insights into corporate finance before moving to multinational company Gillette. "I spent my formative years at Gillette," she says. It was there, that she transitioned from corporate finance to treasury. "Treasury was an aspirational role—managing money is always challenging but very interesting," Arora reflects.

Her next stop was at beverage giant Coca-Cola in 2002. Arora, however, sought new challenges. "At that time, the insurance sector was just opening up in India," she recalls. In 2004, she jumped at the opportunity. She has been a founding member of two insurance companies—MetLife India Insurance and Canara HSBC Life Insurance. The more she embraced challenges, the more she thrived. At Canara HSBC, she began receiving mentorship for board positions.

In 2017, the time was ripe for her to make a global move and she joined Allianz. When a regional role came up, it required her relocating to Singapore, which was challenging for her family. "Allianz demonstrated a lot of flexibility to help me make that transition," says Arora.

Now, after almost eight years with Allianz, she leads the Asia hub with an AUM of \$50 billion across 21 operating entities in 12 countries. As she continues to thrive, Arora's canvas is far from complete and awaits many more experiences. **BT**

@anandadhikari